

UX Design Documentation

ChinaScape

Sitemap · Core Feature Flows · Low-Fidelity Wireframes

Design Analysis & Structure Report

02 SITEMAP — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

Overview

The sitemap defines the app's full navigation hierarchy and content structure. It reveals how screens are grouped, how the user moves between sections, and what content lives at each node. The colour coding separates the five top-level sections by domain, making structural relationships immediately legible.

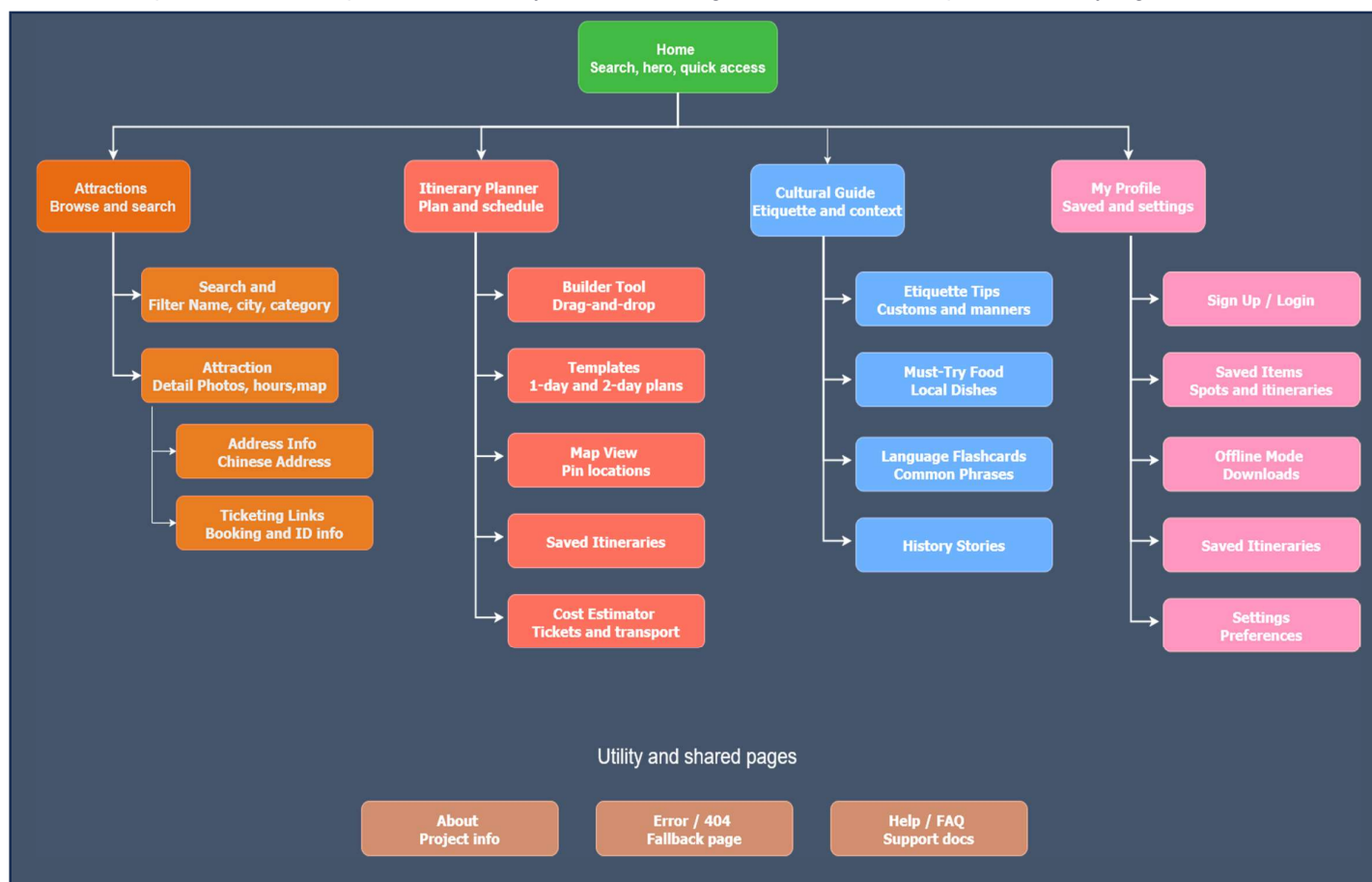


Figure 1 — Full Sitemap / Information Architecture

Structural Analysis

Home (Green — Entry Point)

The root node anchors the entire app. It surfaces a search bar, a hero visual, and quick-access shortcuts, giving first-time users an immediate orientation point and returning users a fast path to their goal.

Attractions (Orange — Core Content)

Four child nodes cover the complete attraction discovery loop: search/filter, a detail page (photos, hours, map), a Chinese address display for navigation, and ticketing/booking links. The depth is deliberately shallow — three taps maximum from Home to booking.

Itinerary Planner (Red/Coral — Planning Hub)

Six sub-pages support the full planning workflow: a drag-and-drop builder, 1-day and 2-day templates, a map view with pinned locations, saved itineraries, and a cost estimator covering tickets and transport.

Cultural Guide (Blue — Contextual Education)

Four content categories enrich the trip: Etiquette Tips, Must-Try Food, Language Flashcards, and History Stories. This section differentiates the app from a simple map tool by offering cultural guides.

My Profile (Pink — User Persistence)

Covers authentication, saved content (spots and itineraries), offline mode with downloads, and general settings. The offline download option is a strategic feature for travellers with limited data abroad.

Utility Pages (Brown — Support Layer)

About, Error/404, and Help/FAQ are presented as footer-level utilities — present when needed but never competing with primary navigation.

03 CORE FEATURE FLOWS

The four use-case diagrams map the primary user journeys through the app. Each flow uses industry-standard notation: rounded rectangles for states/actions, decision diamonds for branching logic, and directed arrows for transitions. Together they cover the most critical paths a user will take.

UC1 — Search & View Attraction

This flow governs the primary discovery loop. The user opens the app, enters a search query (by name, city, or category), and receives a results list of cards. A decision node — 'Attraction found?' — handles the failure state by looping the user back to search. On success, the user lands on a detail page and optionally saves the attraction to their profile before the session ends.

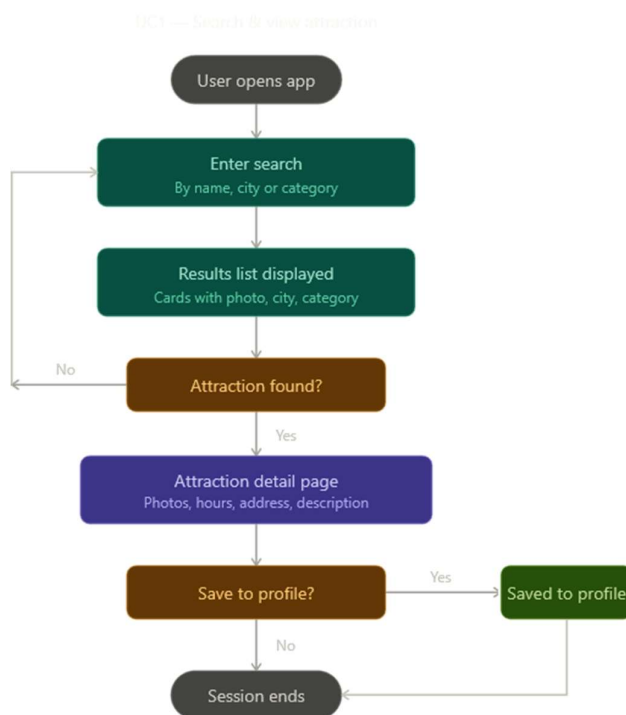


Figure 2 — UC1: Search & View Attraction Flow

Colour Coding: Dark teal nodes represent information-input steps; purple indicates destination/reward states (the detail page); brown marks decision points. This three-tone system makes the flow scannable at a glance.

Explicit Failure Path: The 'No' branch from 'Attraction found?' loops back to search rather than terminating a UX choice that keeps the user in the task rather than abandoning them.

Optional Save: The save action is positioned post-discovery, respecting intent: users explore first, commit second.

UC2 — Browse Attractions Grid

UC2 documents the broader attractions browsing experience, covering how users apply filters, scroll through a card grid, and interact with individual attraction entries. The diagram is wider-format, reflecting the multi-path nature of browsing versus the linear funnel of directed search. Filter combinations, category tabs, and city selectors branch the flow into parallel discovery lanes.

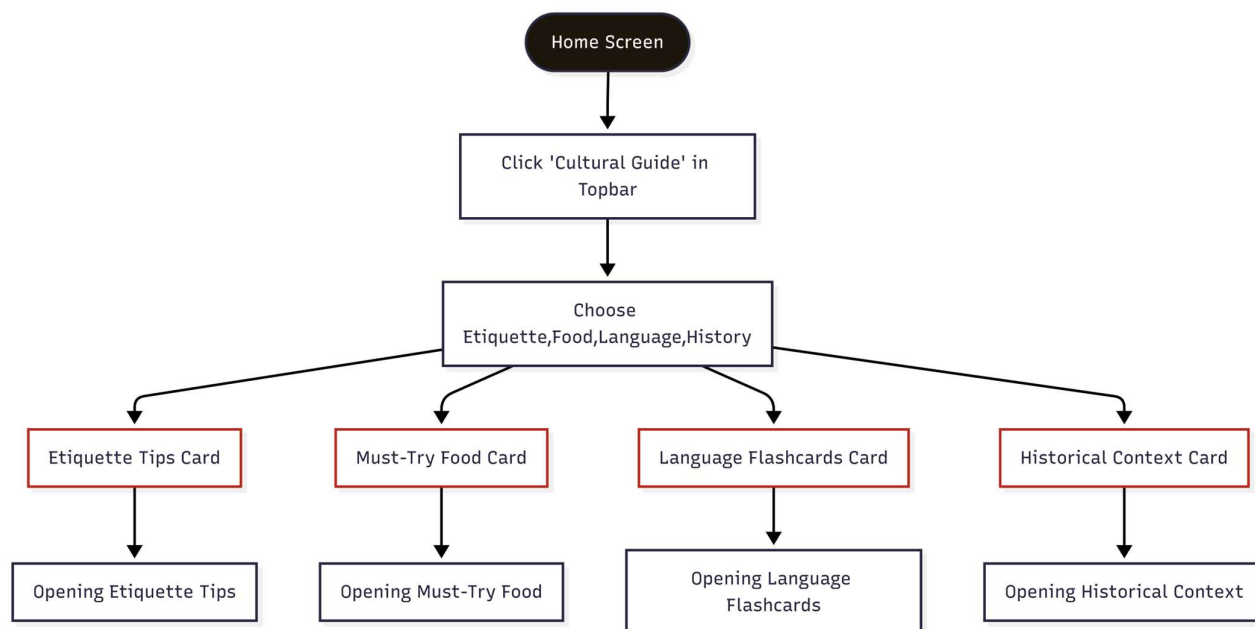


Figure 3 — UC2: Browse Attractions Grid Flow

The wide canvas chosen for this diagram reflects the breadth of the browsing interaction space. Multiple entry conditions and filter combinations are shown simultaneously, communicating that this screen must handle high interaction variability without overwhelming the user.

UC3 — Cultural Guide Interaction

UC3 covers the Cultural Guide section flow, how users navigate from the guide landing page into one of the four content categories (Etiquette Tips, Must-Try Food, Language Flashcards, Historical Context) and interact with the content within. The compact diagram reflects the simplicity of the interaction: select a category, consume content, optionally save or return.

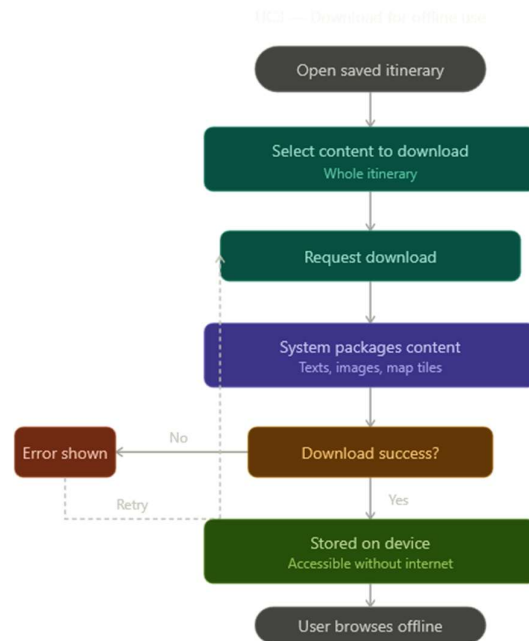


Figure 4 — UC3: Cultural Guide Flow

The deliberate simplicity of UC3 is a design statement: the Cultural Guide must not feel like a separate app. The shallow depth (two taps to content) ensures cultural context is always within reach during an attraction visit.

UC4 — Itinerary Builder

UC4 is the most complex flow, reflecting the multi-step nature of itinerary planning. The user begins by choosing between Manual and Auto plan types — a key bifurcation. Auto mode routes through template selection (1-day or 2-day); Manual mode skips directly to attraction selection. Both paths converge at the drag-and-drop ordering step, followed by cost estimation and itinerary saving.

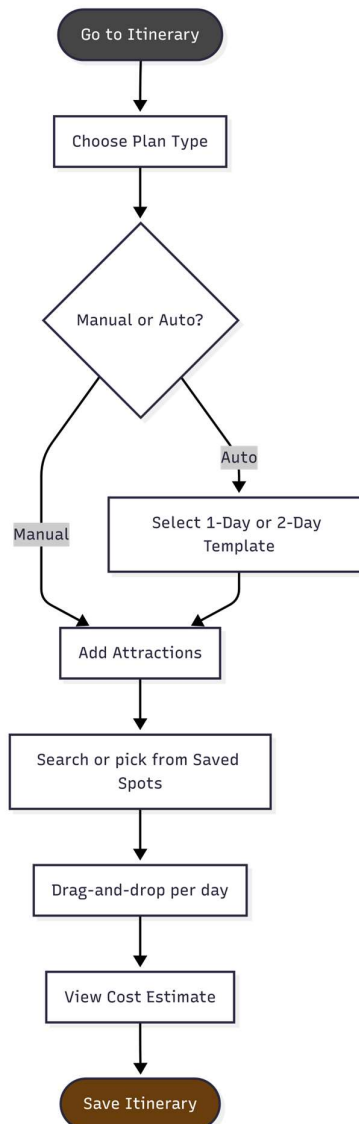


Figure 5 — UC4: Itinerary Builder Flow

Dual Entry Path: Manual vs Auto is a best-practice pattern for accommodating both novice users (templates) and experienced planners (direct control). The paths converging at 'Add Attractions' reduces code duplication and creates a consistent mid-flow experience.

Cost Estimator Placement: Placing cost estimation before the final save gives users a natural review checkpoint — reducing plan abandonment after booking.

Low-fidelity wireframes strip away colour, imagery, and final typography to focus purely on layout, hierarchy, and content placement. These five screens correspond directly to the sitemap's primary sections and the feature flows documented above. Each uses bold outlines and placeholder blocks to communicate structure without premature visual commitment.

Screen 1 — Home / Attractions Browse

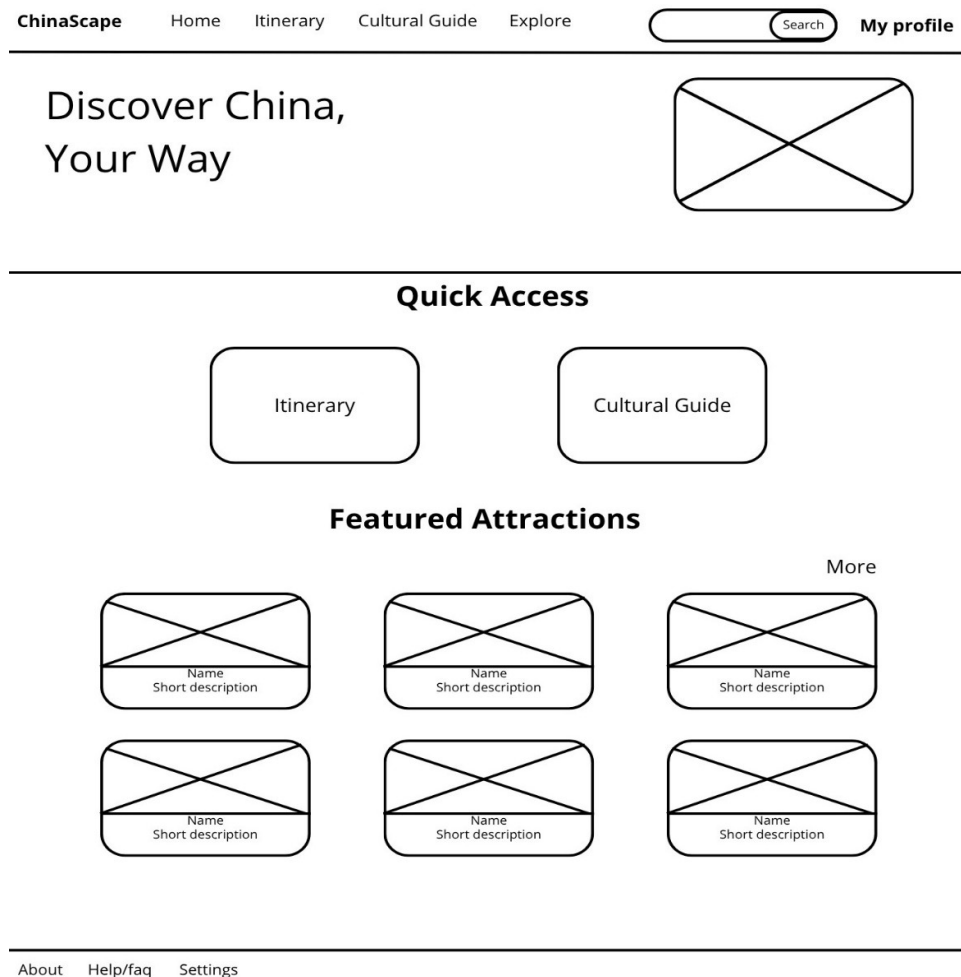
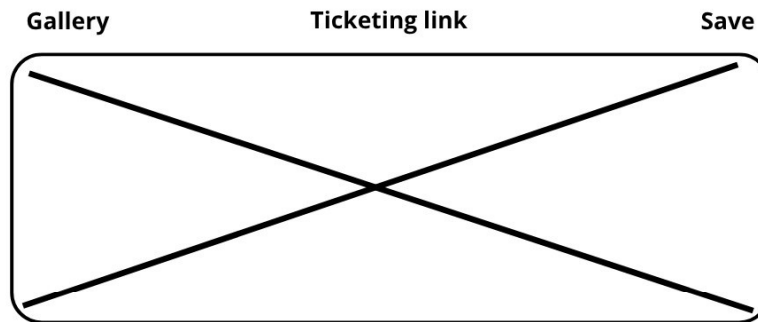


Figure 6 — Wireframe: Home / Attractions Screen

The home screen employs a stacked card layout for attraction results. A prominent search field sits at the top, establishing the primary interaction. Filter chips below the search bar allow category/city narrowing. Cards use a consistent structure (image block, title, city tag) to create a scannable, rhythm-based grid. The hamburger menu (top-left) and a profile shortcut (top-right) bracket the header — a standard mobile navigation pattern that minimises chrome while preserving access.

Screen 2 — Attraction Detail

[My profile](#)

Name | Category: | Hours:

Chinese name () | | Address/Chinese Address | | ID/Passport: Required for entry

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Figure 7 — Wireframe: Attraction Detail Screen

The detail screen prioritises imagery at the top — a full-width photo block commands attention and sets the emotional tone before factual content. Below, structured blocks present hours, address (with the Chinese address explicitly called out for navigation use), and ticketing links. A 'Save' action is accessible without scrolling, reinforcing the flow decision from UC1. The layout follows an F-pattern reading flow: image → name → details → action.

Screen 3 — Itinerary Planner

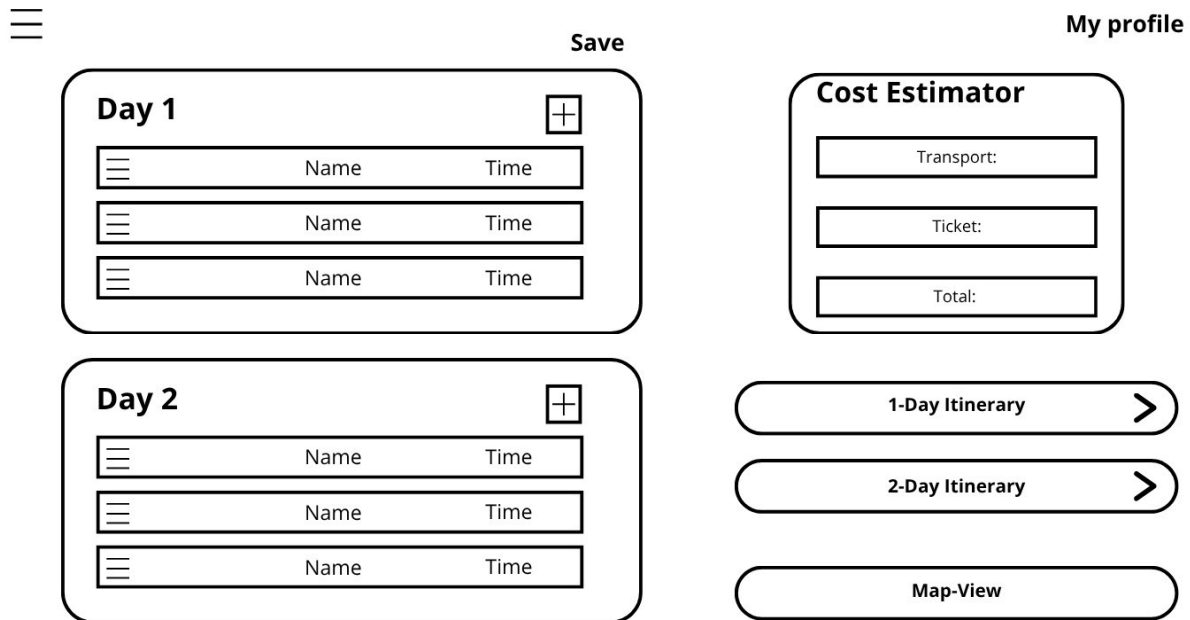


Figure 8 — Wireframe: Itinerary Planner Screen

The planner wireframe introduces a day-based column structure for drag-and-drop scheduling. Placeholder blocks in each day column represent draggable attraction cards. A cost summary bar is anchored to the bottom of the screen, ensuring budget awareness is persistent. Template selection buttons (1-day / 2-day) are positioned at the top, directly mapping to the UC4 Auto path.

Screen 4 — Cultural Guide

[My profile](#)

Cultural Guide



Figure 9 — Wireframe: Cultural Guide Screen

The Cultural Guide uses a bold card-list layout with four clearly separated items. Each card combines an emoji icon (providing a visual cue without requiring an image asset), a capitalised title for high scannability, a one-line descriptor, and a right-pointing chevron as a universal 'navigate deeper' affordance. The consistent card structure makes all four categories feel equally prominent — no single topic is visually deprioritised. Black-on-white with strong typography ensures readability in bright outdoor conditions.

Screen 5 — My Profile

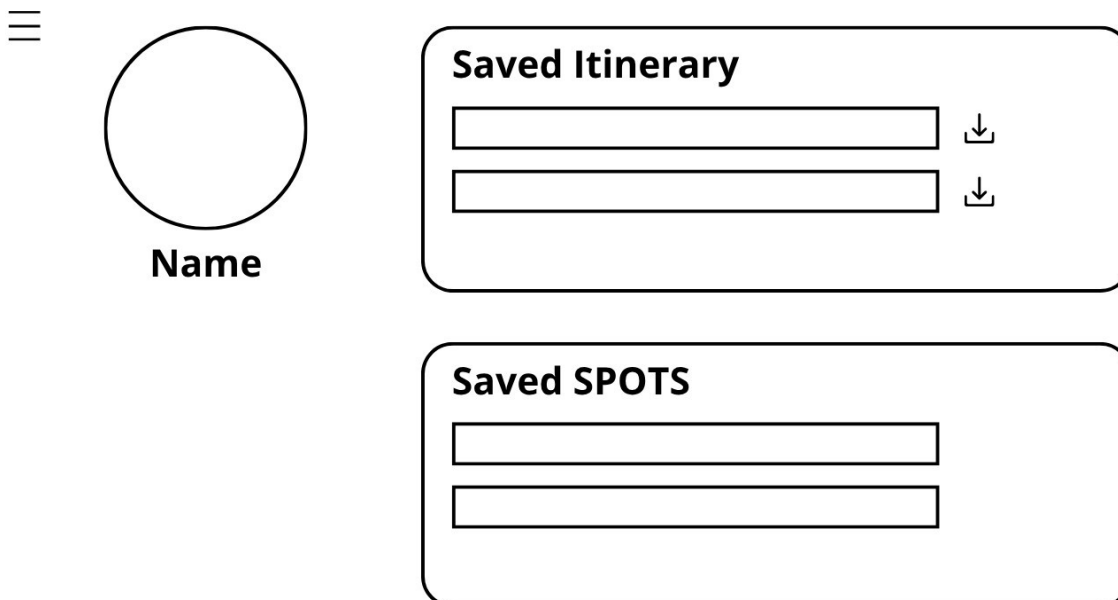


Figure 10 — Wireframe: My Profile Screen

The profile screen adopts a clean two-panel information architecture: a circular avatar with name label (left column), and two content cards (right column) for 'Saved Itinerary' and 'Saved Spots'. Download icons alongside saved itineraries surface the offline mode capability directly on the profile — making it discoverable without requiring a settings deep-dive. Placeholder bars inside each card communicate list content without specifying data, keeping the wireframe tool-agnostic.

05 DESIGN CHOICES & RATIONALE

This section synthesises the recurring design decisions observed across all three artefact types and explains the rationale behind each choice.

1. Colour-Coded Information Architecture

The sitemap assigns a distinct hue to each top-level section (orange for Attractions, coral for Itinerary Planner, blue for Cultural Guide, pink for My Profile, brown for utilities). This colour logic directly informs the eventual UI — each section can carry its own accent colour, giving users a persistent spatial orientation cue as they navigate. It also makes the sitemap itself faster to read in stakeholder reviews.

2. Shallow Navigation Depth

No primary task requires more than three taps from the Home screen. This is a deliberate tourist-experience decision: users are often in unfamiliar environments, under time pressure, and may have limited data connectivity. Deep navigation hierarchies increase cognitive load and error rates in these conditions.

3. Explicit Offline Mode

The inclusion of Offline Mode / Downloads in the profile section — and its surface-level placement in the wireframe — reflects a core user need: international data roaming is expensive and unreliable. Designing offline access as a first-class feature rather than a buried setting signals its strategic importance to the product.

4. Dual-Mode Itinerary Building (Manual vs Auto)

Offering both manual and template-based planning respects different user expertise levels. First-time visitors to China benefit from curated 1-day and 2-day templates; returning travellers or independent explorers prefer manual control. Converging both paths at the drag-and-drop step creates a single, learnable interaction model.

5. Low-Fidelity Wireframe Aesthetic Choices

The wireframes deliberately use only black, white, and bold outlines — no colour, no final typography, no real imagery. This is standard UX practice: it prevents stakeholders from focusing on visual polish before the layout is validated, and it makes feedback sessions more productive by keeping discussion at the structural level.

6. Emoji as Functional Icons in Cultural Guide

The wireframe for the Cultural Guide uses emoji (handshake, noodle bowl, speaking head, book) as icon proxies. This is pragmatic at the lo-fi stage — it communicates category identity without requiring icon asset creation, while signalling that the final UI should use distinct visual identifiers for each content type.

7. Chinese Address as a Distinct Field

The Attraction Detail screen specifically calls out 'Chinese Address' as a separate data field. This is a critical localisation decision: international tourists need the address in Chinese script to show taxi drivers or input into local navigation apps. Treating it as a distinct, copyable field rather than a secondary data point elevates a high-friction moment in the user journey.

8. Cost Estimator as a Planning Checkpoint

Embedding cost estimation within the Itinerary Builder (rather than at checkout) positions budget awareness as a planning tool rather than a surprise. This reduces post-plan abandonment and builds trust — the app helps users stay within budget, not just book experiences.

9. Standard Mobile Navigation Patterns

All wireframes consistently use a hamburger menu (top-left) for secondary navigation and a profile shortcut (top-right). This conforms to established mobile conventions, reducing the learning curve for new users and ensuring the app feels immediately familiar regardless of prior experience with similar products.

10. Flowchart Notation Consistency

All four core feature flow diagrams use a consistent visual language: rounded rectangles for process steps, sharp diamonds for decisions, and directional arrows for transitions. This consistency means any team member can read any diagram without a legend — reducing onboarding time for developers and QA engineers working from these flows.

06 SUMMARY

The three artefact sets presented in this document form a coherent, layered UX design foundation. The sitemap establishes a clear, colour-coded information architecture with shallow navigation depth. The four core feature flows map the critical user journeys, discovery, browsing, cultural learning, and itinerary building, with explicit handling of failure states and decision branches. The five low-fidelity wireframes translate those flows into spatial layouts, establishing content hierarchy and interaction affordances without premature visual commitment.

Taken together, the design artefacts reflect a product philosophy centred on three principles: clarity for users in unfamiliar environments, cultural depth beyond simple mapping, and practical resilience for real travel conditions (offline mode, Chinese address display, cost estimation). The next phase of design work should move these artefacts into high-fidelity mockups, applying the colour system implied by the sitemap and validating layouts through usability testing.